IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 09

CREATIVITY AND ART

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you like art?
- Did you draw or paint as a child?
- Do you enjoy visiting museums?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe someone creative you know.

You should say:

- who the person is
- how you know them
- what they create
- why you think they are creative

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Can creativity be taught?
- Should schools spend more time on art and music?
- Do artists deserve government funding?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “creativity and art” card

- A creative person you know
- A piece of art you like
- A time you made something yourself
- A museum or gallery you visited
- A painting or photograph you like
- A song or piece of music that is important to you
- A craft or skill you would like to learn
- A building with interesting design

Who the person is → **How** you know them → **What** they create → **Why** they are creative

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing art and artworks

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 thought-provoking

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'yga toldiradigan, fikrlantiradigan • *making you think deeply about an important idea or question*

BAND 8 STORY

Last spring I saw a **thought-provoking** exhibition in Tashkent about plastic waste in rivers. One photo of a child fishing among bottles stayed in my head for days, and I ended up volunteering at a clean-up.

≈ **food for thought** — o'ylantiradigan narsa

≈ **eye-opening** — ko'zni ochadigan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Film, kitash yoki rasm jiddiy mavzuni ko'targanda ishlating: a thought-provoking film/exhibition. Part 1 va Part 2 da 'interesting' o'rniga ayting.

Namuna gap: I prefer **thought-provoking** street art to pretty landscapes, because it makes people stop and talk.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 eye-catching

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

e'tiborni tortadigan, ko'zga tashlanadigan • *so bright or unusual that people notice it at once*

BAND 8 STORY

The poster in our school hall was so **eye-catching** that nobody could walk past it. It was all red and gold, and thanks to it, our drama club sold out every seat.

≈ **striking** — ta'sirchan, ko'zga yaqqol tashlanadigan

≈ **attention-grabbing** — e'tiborni jalb qiluvchi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rang, plakat, dizayn yoki kiyim haqida gapirganda ishlating. 'beautiful' dan ko'ra aniqroq va tabiiyroq. Odatda sifat sifatida: an eye-catching design.

Namuna gap: The mural on the market wall is so **eye-catching** that tourists stop to take photos every morning.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 a true masterpiece

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

haqiqiy durdona asar • *an extremely good work of art that is among the best of its kind*

BAND 8 STORY

When I stood in front of a miniature in the Samarkand museum, I realised it was **a true masterpiece**. Every tiny flower had been painted with a single hair, and I forgot about my phone completely.

≈ **a work of genius** — dahoning asari

≈ **a timeless classic** — abadiy klassika

Qachon ishlatiladi: Juda yuqori baho berishda ishlating: a masterpiece of + noun yoki 'regarded as a masterpiece'. Hamma narsaga ishlatmang, faqat haqiqatan ajoyib asarga.

Namuna gap: Many critics regard this short film as **a true masterpiece** of modern storytelling.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 vivid colours

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yorqin, jonli ranglar • *strong, bright colours that look full of life*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandmother's silk scarf, with its **vivid colours**, always catches my eye at weddings. She chose each shade herself at the Chorsu bazaar, and the scarf still looks brand new after twenty years.

≈ **rich colours** — to'yingan ranglar

≈ **bold colours** — dadil, kuchli ranglar

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(sifat) aniq, ravshan (xotira, tasvir) — I have a **vivid** memory of my first drawing lesson.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasm, mato yoki manzarani tasvirlashda ishlating: painted in vivid colours / a vivid blue. 'vivid' ayni paytda 'vivid memory' (aniq xotira) ma'nosida ham keladi.

Namuna gap: Uzbek ceramics are famous for their **vivid colours**, especially the deep turquoise from Rishton.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 attention to detail

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

mayda tafsilotlarga e'tibor • *the habit of noticing and caring about small parts of something*

BAND 8 STORY

What impressed me about the carpet was its **attention to detail**. The weaver had spent months on tiny patterns that most visitors would never notice, and that patience made me respect craftsmanship much more.

≈ **a keen eye for detail** — tafsilotni payqaydigan ko'z

≈ **painstaking care** — juda sinchkovlik bilan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hunarmand yoki rassomning mahoratini maqtashda ishlating: with great attention to detail / show attention to detail. Ko'plik emas, 'detail' birlikda keladi.

Namuna gap: Her **attention to detail** is what makes her embroidery look almost like a photograph.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 bold brushstrokes

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

dadil cho'tka zarbalari • *strong, confident marks made with a paintbrush*

BAND 8 STORY

My art teacher painted a stormy sky in just a few **bold brushstrokes** while we watched in silence. I'd always been scared of making mistakes, but seeing her work so freely changed my attitude.

≈ **expressive strokes** — ifodali chizgilar

≈ **loose brushwork** — erkin cho'tka ishi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasm uslubini tasvirlashda ishlating: painted in bold brushstrokes. 'brushstroke' sanaladigan ot (a brushstroke, brushstrokes). Part 2 da rassom haqida gapirganda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The artist captured the whole market scene in a handful of **bold brushstrokes**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 leave room for interpretation

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

turlicha talqin qilishga o‘rin qoldirmoq • *to be unclear enough that people can understand it in their own way*

BAND 8 STORY

I love abstract paintings because they **leave room for interpretation**. My brother saw an angry sea in one canvas, while I saw a calm sunrise, and we argued about it happily all the way home.

≈ **be open to interpretation** — talqinga ochiq bo‘lmoq

≈ **invite different readings** — turli o‘qishga chorlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Abstrakt san’at, she’r yoki film haqida gapirganda ishlating: leave plenty of room for interpretation. Ayniqsa Part 3 da san’atning qiymatini muhokama qilishda foydali.

Namuna gap: Good poetry should **leave room for interpretation** instead of explaining everything to the reader.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 stand the test of time

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqt sinoviga bardosh bermoq • *to stay popular or valuable for a very long time*

BAND 8 STORY

Navoi’s poems have **stood the test of time**: my grandfather still recites them by heart, and now my little sister does too. That tells me real art never goes out of fashion.

≈ **remain timeless** — abadiy bo‘lib qolmoq

≈ **last for generations** — avlodlar davomida saqlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Asar, an’ana yoki g‘oya uzoq yillar qadrini yo‘qotmasa ishlating. Part 3 da klassik va zamonaviy san’atni taqqoslashda juda foydali. Odatda: has stood the test of time.

Namuna gap: Few modern songs will **stand the test of time** the way old folk melodies have.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 an acquired taste

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

odatlanib keyin yoqadigan narsa • *something you only learn to enjoy after trying it several times*

BAND 8 STORY

At first I found modern jazz noisy, but my teacher said it was **an acquired taste**. After a month of listening on the bus every day, I suddenly started to love it.

≈ **not to everyone’s taste** — hamma didiga mos emas

≈ **grow on someone** — asta-sekin yoqib qolmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(taom, ichimlik uchun) odat qilgandan keyin yoqadigan — Black olives are **an acquired taste**, but now I can’t live without them.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Dastlab yoqmaydigan, lekin vaqt o‘tib yoqadigan san’at, musiqa yoki taom haqida ishlating: X is an acquired taste. Part 1 da ‘Do you like...?’ savollariga ajoyib javob.

Namuna gap: Abstract art is **an acquired taste**, so I didn’t enjoy it until I learned the stories behind it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 visually striking

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

ko‘rinishi ta’sirchan • *having an appearance that is very impressive and memorable*

BAND 8 STORY

The new theatre in our city is **visually striking**, with a glass roof that glows at night. I went there for a ballet, but honestly I spent the first ten minutes just staring at the building.

≈ **breathtaking** — hayratomuz

≈ **stunning** — ajoyib, lol qoldiruvchi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bino, rasm yoki sahna dizaynini maqtash uchun rasmiyroq va aniqroq ibora. Adverb + adjective modeli: visually stunning / visually appealing. Part 2 uchun foydali.

Namuna gap: The film was **visually striking**, though the story itself felt a little weak.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 come up with an idea

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

g‘oya o‘ylab topmoq • *to think of a plan or suggestion*

BAND 8 STORY

I was stuck on my school project until I suddenly **came up with** an idea during a bus ride: we could make lamps from recycled bottles. My teammates loved it, and it won first prize.

≈ **hit upon an idea** — tasodifan g‘oyaga duch kelmoq

≈ **dream up** — o‘ylab chiqarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi g‘oya, reja yoki yechim topganda ishlating: come up with + a plan/solution/idea. ‘find an idea’ demang, bu noto‘g‘ri.

Namuna gap: Designers often **come up with** their best ideas when they stop trying so hard.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 think outside the box

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

odatiy doiradan tashqarida fikrlamoq • *to think in a new, original way instead of following normal rules*

BAND 8 STORY

Our budget was tiny, so my friend told us to **think outside the box**. We borrowed old doors from a market and turned them into stage walls, and the audience thought it was a clever design.

≈ **take a fresh approach** — yangicha yondashmoq

≈ **break the mould** — qolipni buzmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ijodiy yechim haqida gapirganda ishlating: encourage students to think outside the box. Biroz keng tarqalgan, shuning uchun bitta javobda bir martadan ortiq ishlatmang.

Namuna gap: Schools should teach children to **think outside the box** rather than memorise answers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 spark my imagination

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tasavvurimni uyg‘otmoq • *to start my imagination working and make me want to create*

BAND 8 STORY

A single photograph of the Registan at sunrise **sparked my imagination**. I went home and wrote a whole short story about a boy who lives inside its tiles, and my teacher asked to read it aloud.

≈ **fire my imagination** — tasavvurimni alangalatmoq

≈ **fuel my creativity** — ijodimga turtki bermoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: spark/fire/capture + imagination shaklida ishlating: spark someone’s imagination. Bolalik xotiralari yoki ilhom manbai haqida gapirganda juda mos.

Namuna gap: Reading fairy tales as a child **sparked my imagination** and made me want to draw the characters.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 let your imagination run wild

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tasavvuringizga erk bermoq • *to allow yourself to imagine anything without limits*

BAND 8 STORY

In our drawing class the teacher told us to forget the rules and **let our imagination run wild**. I drew a flying bazaar full of dragons, and for the first time I enjoyed art instead of fearing it.

≈ **give free rein to** — erkinlik bermoq

≈ **let your mind wander** — fikringiz sayr qilsin

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bolalar ijodi, hikoya yozish yoki rasm chizish haqida gapirganda ishlating. Buyruq shaklida yoki 'let my imagination run wild' tarzida keladi.

Namuna gap: Children should be allowed to **let their imagination run wild** during art lessons.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 draw inspiration from

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

...dan ilhom olmoq • *to get ideas and energy for your own work from something*

BAND 8 STORY

My cousin **draws inspiration from** old suzani patterns when she designs dresses. She walks through the Tashkent bazaar every Sunday, sketching motifs, and her collection now sells in two shops.

≈ **take inspiration from** — ...dan ilhom olmoq

≈ **be inspired by** — ...dan ilhomlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ilhom manbasini ayting: draw inspiration from + nature/history/people. 'inspiration of' demang, doim 'from'. Part 2 da ijodkor haqida gapirishda juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Many young artists **draw inspiration from** traditional crafts and give them a modern twist.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 a flash of inspiration

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

to'satdan kelgan ilhom • *a sudden, powerful idea that comes without warning*

BAND 8 STORY

I'd been staring at a blank page all evening, and then, in **a flash of inspiration**, I imagined the story starting at a railway station. I wrote until midnight without once checking my phone.

≈ **a stroke of genius** — dahoviy fikr

≈ **a eureka moment** — "topdim!" lahzasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ijodiy g'oya to'satdan kelgan voqeani hikoya qilishda ishlating: in a flash of inspiration / have a flash of inspiration. Hikoya uslubidagi Part 2 uchun juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The best song I ever wrote came to me in **a flash of inspiration** on a night train.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 express myself

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zimni ifoda qilmoq • *to show my feelings and thoughts clearly through words or art*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m quite shy in class, but with a pencil in my hand I can **express myself** freely. My sketchbook is the one place where I say exactly what I feel, even if nobody ever sees it.

≈ **get my feelings across** — his-tuyg‘ularimni yetkazmoq

≈ **find my voice** — o‘z ovozimni topmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ijod orqali his-tuyg‘uni bildirishda ishlating: express myself through + music/painting/writing. ‘express myself’ o‘zim haqimda emas, balki his-tuyg‘ularim haqida.

Namuna gap: Painting gives teenagers a healthy way to **express themselves** when they can’t find the words.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 trial and error

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

sinov va xatolar usuli • *learning by trying different ways and correcting your mistakes*

BAND 8 STORY

I taught myself pottery through **trial and error**. My first ten bowls cracked in the oven, which was frustrating, but by the eleventh I’d learnt how thick the clay should be.

≈ **learn the hard way** — achchiq tajribada o‘rganmoq

≈ **learn by doing** — qilib o‘rganmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: O‘z-o‘zidan o‘rganish haqida gapirganda ishlating: by/through trial and error. Artikl ishlatilmaydi. Hunar va ijodiy mahorat haqida Part 2 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Most self-taught artists improve through **trial and error** rather than formal lessons.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 put my heart and soul into

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

butun qalbimni bag‘ishlamoq • *to give a great deal of effort and emotion to something*

BAND 8 STORY

For two months I **put my heart and soul into** painting a mural for our mahalla. I worked after school in the rain, and when the neighbours clapped on the opening day, every tired evening felt worth it.

≈ **pour my energy into** — kuch-quvvatimni sarflamoq

≈ **devote myself to** — o‘zimni bag‘ishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ishga katta mehnat va tuyg‘u sarflaganingizni aytishda ishlating: put your heart and soul into + noun/-ing. Yakuniy natijadan faxrlanishni ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: Real artists **put their heart and soul into** every piece, even when nobody is watching.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 bring an idea to life

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

g‘oyani hayotga tatbiq etmoq • *to turn an idea into something real that people can see*

BAND 8 STORY

I had the story in my head for years, but it took a patient editor to help me **bring** it **to life**. Seeing the printed book for the first time, I honestly had tears in my eyes.

≈ **turn an idea into reality** — g‘oyani voqelikka aylantirmoq

≈ **make it a reality** — uni haqiqatga aylantirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(personaj, hikoya haqida) jonlantirmoq — The actor really **brought** the old poet **to life** on stage.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Loyiha yoki ijodiy g‘oyani amalga oshirish haqida gapirganda ishlating: bring + idea/character/design + to life. Ish va ijod mavzusida ham keladi.

Namuna gap: Modern software lets young designers **bring** their ideas **to life** faster than ever before.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describing a creative person

21 have a flair for

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga qobiliyati bor, ...ga mahorat • *to have a natural talent for doing something well*

BAND 8 STORY

My sister **has a flair for** colour. She once rearranged our living room with just a few cushions and a scarf, and my mother couldn't believe it was the same room.

≈ **have a gift for** — ...ga iste'dodi bor

≈ **have a knack for** — ...ga mahorat bilan ega bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tug'ma qobiliyatni maqtashda ishlating: have a flair for + noun/-ing (have a flair for design/cooking). Part 2 da ijodkor odamni tasvirlashda 10 balllik ibora.

Namuna gap: He **has a flair for** turning ordinary objects into funny sculptures.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 a creative streak

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ijodkorlik xususiyati • *a natural tendency to be imaginative and original*

BAND 8 STORY

My dad is an accountant, but he has **a creative streak**: every birthday he writes a rhyming poem for each of us. It started as a joke, and now our whole family waits for it.

≈ **an artistic side** — badiiy tomoni

≈ **an imaginative mind** — tasavvurga boy aql

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odamning ijodkor tomonini aytishda ishlating: have a creative streak. 'streak' odatda xarakterning ma'lum bir qismi: a stubborn streak, a rebellious streak.

Namuna gap: Even the most serious people usually have **a creative streak** if you give them a chance.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 a vivid imagination

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

boy tasavvur • *an ability to picture things clearly and in great detail*

BAND 8 STORY

My little brother has **a vivid imagination**: he can turn a cardboard box into a spaceship for an entire afternoon. When he explains his adventures at dinner, we all forget to eat.

≈ **an active imagination** — faol tasavvur

≈ **a fertile imagination** — unumdor tasavvur

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odam yoki bolaning tasavvurini maqtashda ishlating: have a vivid imagination. Ba'zan 'o'ylab topgan' ma'nosida ham keladi, shuning uchun kontekstni ko'ring.

Namuna gap: Writers with **a vivid imagination** can make an invented city feel more real than a real one.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 naturally gifted

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tabiatan iste'dodli • *born with a special ability that does not need to be learned*

BAND 8 STORY

Our neighbour's daughter is **naturally gifted** at drawing. She never took a lesson, yet at eight she drew portraits of every guest at her birthday, and the likeness was uncanny.

≈ **born talent** — tug'ma iste'dod

≈ **highly talented** — juda iste'dodli

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tug'ma qobiliyat haqida gapirganda ishlating: naturally gifted at + noun/-ing. Ammo 'gifted' yolg'iz ishlatilsa ham bo'ladi.

Namuna gap: Some people are **naturally gifted**, but even they need years of practice to become professionals.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 have an eye for

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ni payqash qobiliyatiga ega bo'lmoq • *to be good at noticing and judging a particular quality*

BAND 8 STORY

My friend Aziza **has an eye for** beauty in small things. She noticed that a chipped bowl in a junk shop was handmade and bought it for a few coins; now it sits proudly in her studio.

≈ **have a good eye for** — ...ga yaxshi ko'z bilan qaramoq

≈ **be good at spotting** — payqashga usta bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chiroyli, yangi yoki sifatli narsani payqaydigan odam haqida ishlating: have an eye for + detail/colour/design/bargains. 'have eyes for' demang.

Namuna gap: A good photographer **has an eye for** light, which is something you can't really teach.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 self-taught

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'zi o'rgangan, o'z-o'zidan o'rgangan • *having learned a skill by yourself without a teacher*

BAND 8 STORY

My uncle is a **self-taught** musician who learned the dutar from old recordings. He practised on the balcony every night, and now he plays at weddings across the Fergana Valley.

≈ **learn on your own** — mustaqil o'rganmoq

≈ **teach yourself** — o'zini o'zi o'rgatmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ustozsiz o'rganganlar haqida gapirishda ishlating: a self-taught painter/musician/programmer. Qo'shimcha kuchli taassurot uchun ishtiyoq va mehnatni ham qo'shing.

Namuna gap: Several of the best illustrators I follow online are completely **self-taught**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 a fresh perspective

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yangicha qarash • *a new and different way of looking at something*

BAND 8 STORY

When our class got a new art teacher from abroad, she brought **a fresh perspective** to our lessons. Instead of copying fruit, she asked us to draw the same chair from five strange angles.

≈ **a new angle** — yangi nuqtai nazar

≈ **a unique viewpoint** — o‘ziga xos qarash

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi g‘oya yoki nuqtai nazar kiritgan odam haqida ishlating: bring/offer a fresh perspective on + noun. Part 3 da yoshlar va tajribasizlar hissasini muhokama qilishda ham mos.

Namuna gap: Young designers often bring **a fresh perspective** to very old traditions.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 push the boundaries

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

chegaralarni kengaytirmoq • *to try new things that go beyond what is normally accepted*

BAND 8 STORY

My favourite designer constantly **pushes the boundaries** of traditional Uzbek clothing. She mixes ikat with leather jackets, and although some elders disapprove, young people queue outside her shop.

≈ **break new ground** — yangi yo‘l ochmoq

≈ **challenge conventions** — an’analarga qarshi chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangilikka intilgan rassom, dizayner yoki musiqachi haqida ishlating: push the boundaries of + noun. Part 3 da san’atdagi an’ana va yangilikni muhokama qilishda kuchli.

Namuna gap: Great artists **push the boundaries** even when the public is not ready for their ideas.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 make something from scratch

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hech narsadan, noldan yasamoq • *to create something completely by yourself, without ready-made parts*

BAND 8 STORY

Last winter I decided to **make** a guitar **from scratch**. It took four months, three broken tools and a lot of advice from a carpenter uncle, but the first note I played felt unbelievable.

≈ **build from the ground up** — poydevoridan boshlab qurmoq

≈ **create from nothing** — yo‘qdan yaratmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom, mebel yoki san’at asarini butunlay o‘zingiz yasaganingizni aytishda ishlating: make/bake/build + something + from scratch. Ish va ijod mavzularida mos.

Namuna gap: I love baking bread **from scratch**, because the whole process feels like a little act of creation.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 a man of many talents

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

ko‘p qirrali iste’dod egasi • *a person who is good at several different things*

BAND 8 STORY

My art teacher is **a man of many talents**: he paints portraits, plays the rubab, and even repairs bicycles. During breaks, students gather around him just to see what he’ll invent next.

≈ **a jack of all trades** — har ishning ustasi

≈ **multi-talented** — ko‘p qirrali iste’dodli

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bir nechta sohada kuchli odamni maqtashda ishlating. Ayol uchun ‘a woman of many talents’ yoki ‘multi-talented’. Salbiy ma’no uchun ‘jack of all trades, master of none’.

Namuna gap: She’s **a woman of many talents**, equally at ease with a camera and a paintbrush.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Feelings and why it matters (Part 2)

31 take my breath away

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafasimni qaytarmoq, hayratda qoldirmoq • *to surprise or impress me so much that I cannot speak for a moment*

BAND 8 STORY

The first time I entered the Gur-e-Amir mausoleum, its golden ceiling **took my breath away**. I stood completely still for a minute while my friends laughed at me.

≈ **leave me speechless** — tilimni bog'lab qo'ymoq

≈ **blow me away** — meni lol qildirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Go'zallik yoki ta'sirli manzaradan chuqur hayratni bildirish uchun ishlating: take my breath away / breathtaking. Rasm, musiqa yoki sahnaga ishlatish mumkin.

Namuna gap: That ballet performance **took my breath away**, and I still remember the final scene.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 lose track of time

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqtni unutib qo'ymoq • *to be so busy or focused that you do not notice time passing*

BAND 8 STORY

Whenever I start sketching, I completely **lose track of time**. Last Sunday I sat down after breakfast, and when I looked up it was dark and my tea was cold.

≈ **be completely absorbed** — butunlay berilib ketmoq

≈ **be lost in my work** — ishga sho'ng'ib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mashg'ulotga to'liq berilishni ifodalashda ishlating: lose track of time while + -ing. Hobbi haqida Part 1 va Part 2 da juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Painting is the only hobby that makes me **lose track of time** completely.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 a sense of achievement

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

muvaffaqiyat tuyg'usi • *the proud feeling you get when you finish something difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

When I finally finished the portrait of my grandfather, I felt **a sense of achievement** I'd never had before. It had taken six weeks, and he cried a little when I showed it to him.

≈ **a feeling of pride** — faxrlanish tuyg'usi

≈ **a sense of fulfilment** — ichki qoniqish tuyg'usi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyin ishni tugatgandan keyingi faxrni ifodalashda ishlating: feel/get a sense of achievement. 'sense of accomplishment' ham to'g'ri. Hissiyotni tushuntirishda Part 2 uchun ideal.

Namuna gap: Finishing a handmade gift gives me **a sense of achievement** that shopping never can.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 be blown away by

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...dan hayratda qolmoq • *to be extremely impressed by something*

BAND 8 STORY

I went to a student art fair without any expectations, and I was **blown away by** the quality. A fifteen-year-old had made a lifelike elephant from old newspapers, and I bought a small print of it.

≈ **be amazed by** — ...ga qoyil qolmoq

≈ **be bowled over by** — ...dan lol qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy, samimiy uslubda kuchli taassurotni bildiring: be blown away by + noun. Part 1 va Part 2 da 'surprised' o'rniga ishlating. Rasmiy yozuvda kamroq.

Namuna gap: I was **blown away by** how much emotion one simple sculpture could carry.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 leave a lasting impression

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uzoq yodda qoladigan taassurot qoldirmoq • *to make a strong effect that people remember for a long time*

BAND 8 STORY

Her first exhibition **left a lasting impression** on me. Years later I can still remember the paintings of the old city, and they are the reason I started to study art history.

≈ **make a deep impression** — chuqur taassurot qoldirmoq

≈ **stay with me** — men bilan qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yodda uzoq qoladigan voqea yoki shaxs haqida ishlating: leave a lasting impression on + someone. 'make' ham, 'leave' ham ishlatiladi, lekin 'leave' tabiiyroq.

Namuna gap: A good teacher can **leave a lasting impression** on a student's whole life.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 strike a chord with

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

qalbiga yetib bormoq • *to remind people of their own feelings so that they connect with it*

BAND 8 STORY

His song about leaving home **struck a chord with** me because I'd just moved to Tashkent for university. I listened to it on repeat on the bus, feeling a little less lonely.

≈ **resonate with** — ...ga yaqin bo'lmoq, ...da aks sado bermoq

≈ **hit home** — qattiq ta'sir qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Asar tomoshabin yoki tinglovchining his-tuyg'usiga to'g'ri kelsa ishlating: strike a chord with + someone. Musiqa, kitob va film haqida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: The novel **struck a chord with** thousands of readers who had experienced the same hardship.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 unwind

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

dam olmoq, ruhan tinchlanmoq • *to relax and let go of stress after a hard day*

BAND 8 STORY
After long days at university I like to **unwind** by painting small landscapes. It's not about being good, it's about the calm that spreads through me when the brush touches the paper.

≈ **switch off** — o'chirib qo'ymoq, fikrni dam oldirmoq

≈ **de-stress** — stressdan xalos bo'lmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(ip, g'altak) yozmoq, ochmoq — She slowly **unwound** the thread from the old spindle.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Charchoqni yo'qotish uchun qiladigan ishingiz haqida ishlating: unwind by + -ing / unwind after work. Part 1 da hobbi savoliga javob uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Crafting is a wonderful way to **unwind** when your head is full of exams.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 escape from reality

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

voqelikdan qochmoq • *to forget about everyday problems by entering an imagined world*

BAND 8 STORY
Reading fantasy novels is my way of **escaping from reality**. When exam stress is at its peak, an hour in a magical forest is enough to bring my mood back to normal.

≈ **get away from it all** — hammasidan uzoqlashmoq

≈ **take my mind off things** — fikrimni chalg'itmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kitob, film yoki rasm orqali muammolardan chalg'ishni aytganda ishlating: a great way to escape from reality. Rasmiy ohangda 'form of escapism' ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: For many people, films are a harmless way to **escape from reality**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 add colour to life

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hayotga rang qo'shmoq • *to make life more interesting and enjoyable*

BAND 8 STORY
Music classes **added colour to** my school years. Between grammar drills and exams, the hour with the choir was the one I looked forward to most, and it brought us all closer together.

≈ **brighten up my day** — kunimni yorqin qilmoq

≈ **enrich my life** — hayotimni boyitmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: San'at yoki hobbi hayotni qiziqarli qilishini tushuntirishda ishlating: add colour to + life/the city/a room. Ma'no ham so'zma-so'z, ham majoziy.

Namuna gap: Street murals **add colour to** grey neighbourhoods and make people feel happier.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 get a real buzz out of

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

...dan kuchli zavq olmoq • *to feel excited and energised by doing something*

BAND 8 STORY

I **get a real buzz out of** designing posters for school events. Seeing my work on the walls and hearing classmates talk about it gives me more energy than a cup of coffee.

≈ **get a kick out of** — ...dan zavq olmoq

≈ **be thrilled by** — ...dan hayajonlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy, jonli ibora: get a buzz out of + noun/-ing. Part 1 da sevimli mashg'ulot haqida javobni jonlantiradi. Rasmiy yozuvda 'derive great enjoyment' ishlating.

Namuna gap: I **get a real buzz out of** seeing a blank canvas slowly turn into something beautiful.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: education, funding and culture

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 nurture creativity

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

ijodkorlikni rivojlantirmoq • *to carefully help creative ability grow*

BAND 8 STORY

My primary school did a great job of **nurturing creativity**. Every Friday we built, painted or acted out stories, and it taught me that being different wasn't something to hide.

≈ **encourage creativity** — ijodkorlikni rag'batlantirmoq

≈ **foster creativity** — ijodkorlikni qo'llab-quvvatlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da maktab va ta'lim haqidagi savollarga javob: nurture/foster/encourage creativity in + children/students. 'nurture' ancha chiroyli va kuchli fe'l.

Namuna gap: Schools need to **nurture creativity** just as seriously as they teach maths.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 stifle creativity

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

ijodkorlikni bo'g'moq • *to stop creative ideas from growing by putting too many limits*

BAND 8 STORY

In my old school, rote learning **stifled** our **creativity**. We copied the teacher's drawings exactly, and anyone who tried a different style lost marks, so most of us simply gave up.

≈ **hold back imagination** — tasavvurni to'smoq

≈ **kill creativity** — ijodni o'ldirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qattiq qoidalar, imtihon bosimi yoki tanqidning yomon ta'sirini ko'rsatishda ishlating: stifle + creativity/innovation. 'suppress' ham mumkin, lekin 'stifle' tabiiyroq.

Namuna gap: Too many exams can **stifle creativity** because students only focus on getting the right answer.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 public funding for the arts

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

san'atga davlat moliyalashtirishi • *money from the government to support art, music and culture*

BAND 8 STORY

My city's orchestra survives only because of **public funding for the arts**. Without that support, the tickets would be so expensive that ordinary families could never listen to live music.

≈ **government subsidies** — davlat subsidiyalari

≈ **state support for culture** — madaniyatga davlat ko'magi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 dagi 'Do artists deserve government funding?' savoliga javobda ishlating: public funding for + the arts/museums/theatres. Argument bilan birga ayting.

Namuna gap: I strongly believe **public funding for the arts** pays back through tourism and national pride.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 a well-rounded education

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

har tomonlama ta’lim • *schooling that develops many skills and not just academic ones*

BAND 8 STORY

Looking back, I’m thankful for **a well-rounded education**. Alongside maths and physics, I had art and music, and these lessons gave me confidence to present on stage later.

≈ **a balanced curriculum** — muvozanatli o‘quv dasturi

≈ **a broad education** — keng qamrovli ta’lim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maktabda san’at fanlarining zarurligini asoslashda Part 3 da ishlating: provide a well-rounded education. ‘well-rounded person’ ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Art and music are essential for **a well-rounded education**, not optional extras.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 cultural heritage

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy meros • *the traditions, buildings and art that a country inherits from the past*

BAND 8 STORY

Our **cultural heritage** feels very close when I visit the Itchan Kala fortress in Khiva. Artisans there still carve wood the way their grandfathers did, and I sat for an hour just watching them.

≈ **national treasures** — milliy boyliklar

≈ **age-old traditions** — qadimiy an’analar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da an’ana, tarix va san’atni asrash haqida gapirganda ishlating: preserve/protect/celebrate our cultural heritage. ‘culture heritage’ emas, ‘cultural heritage’.

Namuna gap: Museums play a vital role in preserving a country’s **cultural heritage** for future generations.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 budget cuts

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

byudjetni qisqartirish • *reductions in the money that is available to spend*

BAND 8 STORY

When **budget cuts** hit my school, the first thing to go was the art room. Within a year, students who loved drawing were forced to practise on the back of exam papers.

≈ **cut back on spending** — xarajatlarni qisqartirmoq

≈ **tighten the purse strings** — xarajatni cheklamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ta’lim yoki madaniyatdagi moliyaviy muammolarni muhokama qilishda ishlating: face budget cuts / budget cuts to the arts. Ko‘plikda ‘cuts’ keladi.

Namuna gap: **Budget cuts** often affect arts programmes first, because people think they are less important.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 the creative industries

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ijodiy sohalar • *jobs and businesses such as design, film, music and advertising*

BAND 8 STORY

The creative industries are growing fast in my country. My cousin works for a game studio in Tashkent, and a decade ago nobody would have believed a job like his could even exist.

≈ **the entertainment sector** — ko‘ngilochar soha

≈ **the design sector** — dizayn sohasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da iqtisod va san’at aloqasi haqida ishlating: the creative industries contribute to the economy. ‘the’ artikli bilan ko‘plikda ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: **The creative industries** now give jobs to thousands of young people.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 freedom of expression

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

fikr erkinligi, o‘zini erkin ifoda etish huquqi • *the right to say or show what you think without fear*

BAND 8 STORY

My literature teacher always defended **freedom of expression** in our debates. She said an artist who is afraid to speak will only create safe, boring work, and I’ve believed that ever since.

≈ **creative freedom** — ijodiy erkinlik

≈ **the right to speak out** — ochiq gapirish huquqi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da senzura, san’at va jamiyat haqidagi savollarda ishlating: protect freedom of expression. Bu ibora siyosiy mavzularda ham keladi.

Namuna gap: Artists need **freedom of expression** to challenge ideas that society takes for granted.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 rote learning

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yodlab o‘rganish • *learning by repeating facts again and again without understanding them*

BAND 8 STORY

At my old school **rote learning** was everywhere: we memorised poems without discussing what they meant. I could recite pages, but I couldn’t explain a single feeling behind them.

≈ **learning by heart** — yoddan o‘rganish

≈ **memorise facts** — faktlarni yodlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ta’lim tizimini tanqid qilishda ishlating: rely on rote learning. Odatda salbiy ma’noda. Ijodiy fikrlashga qarshi qo‘yiladi (creative thinking).

Namuna gap: Education based on **rote learning** leaves little space for students to explore their own ideas.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 tap into potential

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

imkoniyatlardan foydalanmoq • *to start using abilities that exist but have not yet been used*

BAND 8 STORY

Our youth centre helps teenagers **tap into** their **potential** through free art workshops. A quiet boy from our street found out he was brilliant at animation, and now he studies design abroad.

≈ **unlock potential** — imkoniyatni ochmoq

≈ **realise their potential** — imkoniyatini namoyon qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da yoshlar, ta'lim yoki ijod haqida gapirishda ishlating: tap into + potential/creativity/talent. Fe'l sifatida 'tap into' ham mazmunli.

Namuna gap: Good teachers help children **tap into** talents they didn't know they had.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I admire most about + noun + is + that/-ing

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Menga eng yoqadigani ... bu ... • *a cleft sentence that puts the main idea at the end for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

What I admire most about my aunt **is** the way she turns old clothes into new designs. She never throws anything away, and watching her work has taught me to value things that others ignore.

≈ **What impresses me most is...** — Meni eng ko'p hayratga soladigani ...ligi

≈ **What stands out is...** — Ajralib turadigani ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 2 da odamni maqtashda urg'u berish uchun ishlating: What + I + admire/love/like + most + is + ... Nuqtai nazarni ajratib, javobni professional qiladi.

Namuna gap: **What I admire most about** local artists **is** their patience, because their work takes months.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 The more..., the more...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qanchalik ... bo'lsa, shunchalik ... • *a double comparative that shows two things increase together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I practised calligraphy, **the more** I enjoyed it. At first my letters looked like worms, but after a few weeks of patient work, my teacher put one of my pages on the wall.

≈ **The sooner..., the better...** — Qancha erta bo'lsa, shuncha yaxshi

≈ **The longer..., the less...** — Qancha uzoq bo'lsa, shuncha kam

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki jarayon birga o'sishini ko'rsatishda ishlating: The + comparative + S + V, the + comparative + S + V. Ko'p adashadigan joy: 'the' ni unutmang.

Namuna gap: **The more** you expose children to art, **the more** confident they become.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Not only is/does + S..., but also...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Nafaqat ..., balki ... • *an inversion that adds a second, stronger point after the first*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only is my cousin a talented painter, **but** she **also** teaches kids for free on weekends. Her classes are always full, and some pupils have already won city competitions.

≈ **As well as being..., she...** — ...dan tashqari, u ham ...

≈ **On top of that,...** — Bundan tashqari, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikkita yutuqni kuchli ta'kidlashda ishlating. Not only dan keyin yordamchi fe'l oldin keladi: Not only is she..., Not only does she... Faqat o'ta formal emas, ochiq nutqda ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Not only does** street art brighten cities, **but** it **also** gives young artists a voice.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 It is + noun/phrase + that + clause

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Aynan ... shuning uchun ... *• a cleft that stresses one part of the sentence*

BAND 8 STORY

It was my grandmother's embroidery **that** first made me love art. As a child I'd sit beside her for hours, copying the flowers with pencil, and that habit turned into my main hobby.

≈ **It was...who...** — Aynan ... kishi ...

≈ **What really inspired me was...** — Meni haqiqatan ilhomlantirgani ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bir bo'lakni ajratib ko'rsatish uchun ishlating: It was + X + that/who + ... Inson uchun 'who' ham mumkin. Part 2 da sababni urg'ulashga mos.

Namuna gap: **It is** the personality of the artist **that** makes a portrait feel alive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 so + adjective + that...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shu qadar ...ki... *• a structure that shows a result or strong effect*

BAND 8 STORY

The sculpture was **so** lifelike **that** I almost spoke to it. I was standing in a quiet hall, and my footsteps echoed, which made the moment feel strangely magical.

≈ **such + noun + that...** — shunday ...ki...

≈ **to the point where...** — ...darajaga yetib

Qachon ishlatiladi: Natijani ko'rsatish uchun ishlating: so + adjective/adverb + that; such + (a/an) + adjective + noun + that. Qo'shimcha: 'that' ni og'zaki nutqda tashlab ketish mumkin.

Namuna gap: The mural was **so** colourful **that** even passing drivers slowed down to look.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 a person whose + noun...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ning ...i bo'lgan odam *• a relative clause that links a person to something belonging to them*

BAND 8 STORY

My best friend is someone **whose** paintings could easily hang in a gallery. She started drawing after her father gave her a small sketchbook, and she hasn't put down her pencil since.

≈ **a person who has...** — ...ga ega odam

≈ **an artist known for...** — ...bilan tanilgan rassom

Qachon ishlatiladi: Egalik munosabatini ifodalashda ishlating: noun + whose + noun + verb. Ko'p adashadigan joy: 'whose' dan keyin artikl kerak emas. Odam yoki narsaga ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: He's an artist **whose** work reflects the history of his hometown.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Having + p.p., S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...gandan keyin, ... • *a perfect participle clause that shows one action finished before another*

BAND 8 STORY

Having spent weeks on the design, I couldn't wait to see it on the wall. I stayed after class to watch the final painting, and the happiness on my teacher's face made everything worthwhile.

≈ **After + -ing,...** — ...gandan keyin

≈ **Once I had..., I...** — ...ganimdan keyin

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki ketma-ket voqeani qisqa va chiroyli bog'lashda ishlating. Ikkala gapning subyekti bir xil bo'lishi shart. Rasmiy ohang, Part 2 hikoyada yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Having studied** art for years, she finally opened her own gallery.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Hardly had + S + p.p. when...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga ulgurmasdanoq, ... • *an inversion for one action happening right after another*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had I opened the sketchbook **when** a stranger asked me to draw her portrait. I was nervous, but ten minutes later she left with a smile, and I realised I'd found my confidence.

≈ **No sooner had...than...** — ...ga ulgurmasdan...

≈ **As soon as...** — ...bilanoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ketma-ket ikki voqeaning tezligini ta'kidlashda ishlating: Hardly had + S + p.p. + when + past simple. Hikoya uslubidagi Part 2 uchun yuqori bahoga yordam beradi.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** the curtain risen **when** the audience burst into applause.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Were it not for + noun, S + would...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lmaganida, ... • *a formal conditional that means 'if it weren't for'*

BAND 8 STORY

Were it not for my art teacher, I would never have entered the competition. She noticed my sketches, pushed me to sign up, and I still thank her every time I pick up a pencil.

≈ **If it weren't for...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida

≈ **But for...** — ...dan boshqa, ... bo'lmasa

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kimgadir minnatdorchilik bildirishda ishlating. Noun/-ing bilan keladi. 'Without' dan ancha yuqori darajali. Mixed conditional bilan ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: **Were it not for** public funding, many small theatres would have closed years ago.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 I wish + S + had + p.p.

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qaniydi, ... bo‘lganida • *a wish about a past action or situation that cannot be changed now*

BAND 8 STORY

I **wish I had started** painting earlier. I wasted my school years believing I wasn’t talented, and only a chance art class in college proved how wrong I was.

≈ **If only I had...** — Qaniydi, ... qilganimda

≈ **I regret not...** — ...maganimdan afsusdaman

Qachon ishlatiladi: O‘tmishdagi afsusni bildirishda ishlating: I wish + past perfect. Hozirgi istak uchun ‘I wish + past simple’ ishlatiladi. ‘If only’ ham xuddi shu ma’noda, lekin kuchliroq.

Namuna gap: I **wish I had learnt** the piano as a child, because I’d be so much better now.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Little did I know + that...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ligini mutlaqo bilmagan edim • *an inversion used in stories when you did not realise something important at the time*

BAND 8 STORY

I joined the pottery club just to meet friends. **Little did I know** it would become my career: a teacher noticed my work and invited me to sell bowls at a local fair.

≈ **I never imagined that...** — ...ligini tasavvur ham qilmagandim

≈ **Unbeknownst to me...** — Menga noma’lum holda...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hikoyada kutilmagan burilishni ko‘rsatishda ishlating: Little did I know + that + clause. Little dan keyin yordamchi fe’l oldinga o‘tadi (did I know). Faqat o‘tmish haqida.

Namuna gap: **Little did** he **know** that his first sketch would be displayed in a museum.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 used to + V / would + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ardim / ...ar edim (odat) • *two ways to describe regular habits in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was small, I **used to** lie on the carpet and draw for hours. Every evening I **would** show my work to my father, and he’d always find something to praise.

≈ **There was a time when I...** — bir paytlar men ...ardim

≈ **I got into the habit of...** — ...ish odatim bor edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: O‘tmishdagi odat uchun ishlating. ‘used to‘ holat va odat uchun, ‘would’ faqat takrorlanuvchi harakat uchun. Qo‘shimcha: be used to + -ing ko‘nikma bildiradi.

Namuna gap: As a child, I **used to** copy cartoons from TV, and that’s how my love for drawing began.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe someone creative you know.

Describe someone creative you know.

You should say:

- who the person is
- how you know them
- what they create
- why you think they are creative

My 1-minute notes

- cousin Madina • illustrator • Tashkent
- know her • grew up together • same mahalla
- draws • book covers • murals
- self-taught • colourful • cheerful style
- creative: fresh ideas • old patterns made modern
- inspires me • I picked up a pencil again

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (who)	The creative person I'd like to talk about is my cousin Madina, who is a self-taught illustrator living in Tashkent. She has always had a creative streak, and honestly, she is the most imaginative person in our family.
P • How I know her	As for how I know her, we grew up in the same mahalla, only two houses apart. Having spent every summer together as children, we used to draw on the pavement with chalk until our mothers called us in for dinner.
P • What she creates	When it comes to what she creates, she mainly designs book covers and paints murals. Last year she covered a whole school wall in vivid colours, and the pupils were blown away by it. What I admire most about her work is her attention to detail, because even a tiny flower in the corner looks perfect.
E • Reason 1	There are two reasons why I think she is so creative. First, she is brilliant at thinking outside the box. She draws inspiration from old suzani patterns, then gives them a modern twist, and the result looks completely fresh.
E • Reason 2	Second, she never stops pushing the boundaries. Not only does she experiment with new styles, but she also teaches children for free on weekends. Were it not for her encouragement, I would never have picked up a pencil again after school.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, Madina is creative because she combines talent, hard work and generosity. Watching her bring ideas to life has made me believe that creativity is something anyone can nurture, and she is the person who has left the strongest impression on me.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of...	Say...
very good painting	a true masterpiece
a nice idea	a flash of inspiration
very talented	naturally gifted
I was surprised	I was blown away
I forgot the time	I lost track of time
new ideas	a fresh perspective
I feel relaxed	it helps me unwind
attractive	eye-catching
bright colours	vivid colours
care about small things	attention to detail
strong lines	bold brushstrokes
it lasts forever	stand the test of time
not everyone likes it	an acquired taste
think differently	think outside the box
it made me imagine	it sparked my imagination
get ideas from	draw inspiration from
show my feelings	express myself
I tried many times	trial and error
I worked with passion	I put my heart and soul into it
make the idea real	bring an idea to life
good at imagining	a vivid imagination
learned alone	self-taught
try new limits	push the boundaries
satisfied with the result	a sense of achievement
escape from daily life	escape from reality